



UNIVERSAL STUDIOS

A+E SUMMER MOVIES

Among our picks: "Jurassic World Rebirth," Pixar's "Elio" and the new man from Krypton.

TV, streaming: 15 shows coming up, including return of "The Bear."



DISNEY/PIXAR



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LIFE+TRAVEL

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Final

Chicago Tribune



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SUNDAY, MAY 25, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM



'An American Soldier'

The improbable homecoming of WWII Army Pvt. James Loyd to Chicago area

By Andrew Carter | Chicago Tribune

A little before 9 on a warm Thursday morning in mid-May, Doug Morgan climbed into the seat of an excavator and positioned the teeth of the bucket just above the centerline of an empty grave. He is 55, with a white beard and a face worn by working in the sun, and he long ago came to view digging graves at Abraham Lincoln National Cemetery as "taking care of my fellow veterans."

Morgan joined the Marines as a teenager and served in Desert Storm. He has worked at Abraham Lincoln for 21 years, helping to fill the gentle green hills in rural Will County with the symmetrical gray-white headstones of American military veterans and their closest family. Some served in peacetime. Some died long after coming home from war. On a busy day, Morgan and his team might dig

15 graves, many of them now for those who served in Vietnam.

It was rare that Morgan and his men knew much about those whose graves they prepared. This was an exception. As Morgan made the first cut into the grass, he knew exactly who it was for. For days, it had been the talk of the cemetery: That a soldier who'd been missing since 1944 had been found. That a World War II veteran, confirmed to have been killed in action, was coming to rest.

Morgan heard about it on the news after the soldier's remains landed at Midway Airport in a flag-draped casket, and then he filled in some of the gaps himself. He knew that Army Pvt. James C. Loyd, a native of Brilliant, Alabama, disappeared during a nighttime firefight

Turn to Soldier, Page 4

Above: Janice Dale, a close relative of Pvt. James C. Loyd, holds an American flag on Tuesday in her home in Valparaiso, Indiana. It was gifted to her to honor the sacrifice and service of her uncle. AUDREY RICHARDSON/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

City's history of racial politics

Long before DOJ probe, tradition has been 'our people hire our people'

By Alice Yin
Chicago Tribune

Mayor Brandon Johnson sat onstage at a cavernous Wood-lawn church and shot back at the criticism that he only cares about hiring Black people with his most forceful defense yet of the representation among his top appointees.

Addressing a Black audience last week, he quoted the Rev. Jesse Jackson: "Our people hire our people." Then one by one, he shouted out six of his Black deputies and a Black-owned business recently awarded an airport contract.

Less than 24 hours later, his remarks reached the walls of President Donald Trump's Justice Department, triggering an investigation into City Hall's hiring practices.

But while Trump's crusade against diversity policies that he views as discriminatory against white Americans is unprecedented, the practice of powerful

Turn to Race, Page 6

INSIDE

Summer to test city's decline in crime rates

Memorial Day historically marks the start of an annual spike in violence that Chicago has tried to shake for decades. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Making contact and doing damage

Pete Crow-Armstrong's big swing adds to the budding lore of his rocketing stardom and magical first part of the season. **Chicago Sports**

TODAY'S WEATHER

High 65
Low 46



Complete Chicagoland forecast on Opinion, Page 12

\$5.75 city and suburbs and elsewhere
177th year No. 145
© Chicago Tribune



Illinois coal plants get pollution exemptions

Trump offers break on rules limiting toxic air emissions

By Michael Hawthorne
Chicago Tribune

For nearly four decades, owners of the Baldwin power plant in southern Illinois managed to avoid the most stringent requirements of the federal Clean Air Act.

The gargantuan coal burner, built during the early to mid-1970s, became the nation's largest source of sulfur dioxide, which creates acid rain and lung-damaging soot. It also was among the top emit-

ters of climate-changing carbon dioxide, smog-forming nitrogen oxide and brain-damaging mercury.

After Baldwin's owners kept the Randolph County plant running for years while skipping the installation of modern pollution controls, a 2005 legal settlement with the U.S. Justice Department forced them to begin reducing noxious emissions that contribute to dirty air in Chicago, and other downwind cites as far away as New York.

Yet the coal plant remains one of the biggest polluters in the Midwest.

Turn to Coal, Page 17



BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Witnessing history

St. Peter's Basilica in Vatican City glows as the sun sets on the Tiber River on May 16. Tribune photographer Brian Cassella gives us a glimpse of the momentous activity during the week of the installation of Pope Leo XIV. **Chicagoland, Page 10**

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